



USE OF ENGLISH LAB
GENERATIVE AI GUIDE

A Guide to Using Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) for Learning

Use of English Lab

FOR SCHOOL AND INDEPENDENT STUDY

2026 EDITION

PURPOSE

To offer criteria for understanding, questioning and guiding the use of generative AI in learning.

SCOPE

This guide supports learners in Use of English Lab, but it does not replace the specific instructions provided for each subject, task, teacher or school policy.

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1. Why do we need a guide to using generative AI?

Generative artificial intelligence is already part of many learning environments. It can be found in reading, writing, information searches, the organisation of ideas and the revision of assignments. Its adoption therefore raises questions that need to be considered in school and study contexts. These include the reliability of the information it produces, the errors it may make, the reproduction of bias, the oversimplification of complex topics, and questions about authorship, independent work and the ways in which knowledge is constructed.

This guide was written because these practices need to be examined and discussed. Its purpose is to encourage critical and responsible reflection on generative AI in education, without losing sight of the formative value of studying, writing and producing knowledge.

2. What is generative AI, and what does using it for learning involve?

Generative AI refers to a range of systems capable of producing text, images, audio, video, code or other content in response to instructions from a user. Their answers are based on statistical patterns learnt during model training. However, these systems often operate as “black boxes”, which means that their internal logic is not always open to inspection or easy to understand.

Furthermore, their responses are not necessarily identical when the same request is made more than once. A single prompt may produce different wording, examples or explanations, even within the same system. Generative AI systems also differ from one another: they may vary in response quality, the tasks they perform best, access to current information, the possibility of retrieving a conversation, and the terms of use of each platform. It is therefore unwise to assume that a generated answer will always remain the same or can always be retrieved later in exactly the same way.

Because of this lack of transparency, explainability becomes important. It refers to the possibility of obtaining clear explanations of how an algorithmic model reaches specific results (Agencia de Acceso a la Información Pública [AAIP], 2024). Without some degree of explainability, people may place unjustified trust in AI systems that do not “understand” the world and cannot guarantee truth, relevance or neutrality.

It can help you to

- explain a concept in different words;
- provide examples, counterexamples or analogies;
- suggest outlines, reading plans or topic maps;
- review the clarity, grammar and organisation of a draft;
- compare approaches, authors or categories;
- support study and practice.

It cannot replace

- critical interpretation of reading material;
- careful reading of a task in its context;
- independent thinking and personal work;
- academic and ethical judgement;
- source verification;

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- responsibility for submitted work;
 - intellectual authorship.

3. Principles for using generative AI in learning

3.1. Learning comes first

Using generative AI is worthwhile when it helps you understand something more fully, review a process or develop new questions. When it takes the place of reading, writing or reasoning, it is no longer supporting learning.

3.2. Academic integrity

Academic integrity also concerns how work is produced, the decisions each learner makes and the forms of support involved in the process. When a text generated wholly or partly by AI is presented as a learner's own without disclosing that assistance, the relationship between production, authorship and responsibility becomes unclear.

3.3. Transparency

When generative AI plays a substantial role in an assignment, that use should be disclosed in accordance with the teacher's instructions or the relevant policy. Transparency is not merely a formality: it helps others understand how the work was produced.

3.4. Data protection and privacy

Using generative AI also raises questions about the information being circulated. Before pasting content into a tool, consider whether it includes personal, sensitive, institutional, unpublished or copyright-protected information.

3.5. Critical thinking

AI responses may be well written and convincing, but this does not make them accurate or relevant. Read them critically, compare them with other sources, and relate them to the task, the assigned material and your own judgement.

4. Risks, limitations and necessary precautions

Common risks

- inventing facts, quotations or references;
- concealing theoretical disagreements and presenting false consensus;
- reproducing cultural, social, linguistic or geopolitical bias;
- producing generic texts with little depth or personal position;
- weakening genuine understanding of a topic;
- circulating private or sensitive information.

Recommended precautions

- always check claims against reliable sources;
- read AI answers alongside other sources rather than treating them as self-sufficient;
- keep a record of how AI was used;
- do not copy and paste responses without critical revision;
- follow the teacher's rules for assessments;

- preserve authorship and take responsibility for the final text.

4.1. Hallucinations and errors

AI sometimes produces claims that sound convincing but are incorrect. This becomes a serious problem when, for example, it invents references, attributes ideas to the wrong authors or presents unverifiable information as fact.

4.2. Bias

Models are trained on large amounts of existing information. Their responses may therefore reproduce stereotypes, inequalities, omissions or hierarchies already present in those materials. This is why it is important to read them attentively and ask what they leave out.

4.3. Dependence

When generative AI consistently takes over summarising, writing, explaining or analysing, it becomes harder to sustain independent work and develop personal judgement. Using it simply to “get the task done” may gradually displace these learning processes.

4.4. Privacy and your digital footprint

Using generative AI also requires us to consider what information is shared and under what conditions it circulates. In Argentina, Personal Data Protection Law 25,326 (2000) makes it especially important to protect personal, sensitive, institutional, unpublished or copyright-protected information entered into these systems.

Check especially carefully whether the material includes:

- your own personal data or somebody else's;
- sensitive information about other people;
- unpublished research drafts shared without permission;
- confidential school or institutional documents;
- material with explicit restrictions on its use.

5. Criteria for pedagogical use of AI

Guiding principle: Discussing generative AI in learning also means considering the continuing importance of reading, writing, analysis and independent work.

5.1. Before reading

- ask for a preliminary explanation of a topic to activate prior knowledge;
- request a list of key concepts to look for in the assigned reading;
- ask for guiding questions to support critical reading.

5.2. While reading

- rephrase complex paragraphs in clearer language;
- compare definitions given by different authors;
- ask for contextualised examples to understand a theoretical category.

5.3. To organise your study

- create reading schedules;
- suggest comparison tables;

- organise scattered notes;
- generate self-assessment or practice questions.

5.4. To improve your writing

- review cohesion, clarity, grammar and repetition;
- identify unclear or imprecise passages;
- explore different ways of organising an introduction or conclusion;
- check whether the text answers the task.

Example of valuable use:

“Read this paragraph I wrote about the concept of platforms. Point out which ideas are unclear, which words I repeat too often, and what questions I could ask myself to deepen the analysis. Do not rewrite the whole text. I want to preserve my voice.”

6. AI in learning and study

Generative AI may be present at different stages of learning, but its significance is not limited to what it enables us to do. Its adoption also changes the process through which work is produced, so it is important to consider the forms of mediation involved in constructing and validating knowledge.

Thinking about generative AI in study is therefore not simply a matter of learning how to use it. It also requires us to examine the conditions under which it produces answers, the information used to build these systems, the selections they make and the problems that may arise in each context.

The RTD approach-Responsible, Transparent and Documented-provides general guidance for the educational use of generative AI (Ministerio de Capital Humano, 2025). Rather than being a technical sequence, it can be understood as an invitation to consider the place of AI in relation to assigned reading, independent intellectual work and the decisions made throughout a study or writing process.

This approach can be complemented by Damm and Eaton’s (2026) GenAI Use Transparency Framework, which proposes calibrating documentation and disclosure according to the extent of AI involvement. The greater the contribution of generative AI to a task, the greater the need for documentation, human review and disclosure.

These technologies are neither neutral nor isolated. They belong to platforms with their own data-processing and usage policies, and their answers may reproduce bias, omit context or present claims requiring verification as valid. UNESCO similarly argues that integrating AI into education requires ethical and pedagogical criteria that strengthen understanding, analysis and critical production in learning processes (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization [UNESCO], 2024).

From this perspective, if AI changes the way work is produced, it also opens up discussion about the place of reading, writing, independent work, personal thought and the development of judgement in learning.

7. Good practice for assignments and assessments

7.1. Before using AI

- Read the complete task instructions.
- Check whether the task permits, restricts or prohibits particular uses.
- Decide which part of the process you want AI to support and which part you will complete independently.

7.2. While using AI

- Write specific prompts.
- Ask it to identify uncertainties, limitations and counterarguments.
- Do not seek closed answers when the task requires analysis.
- Keep a record of prompts and responses when they have made a meaningful contribution to your work.

7.3. After using AI

- Verify information against real, reliable sources.
- Rewrite in your own words and apply your own judgement.
- Assess whether the result strengthens or weakens your understanding.
- Disclose its use when required.

7.4. Generally acceptable uses

- clarifying concepts;
- organising a study plan;
- requesting practice questions;
- reviewing grammar or clarity;
- asking for examples or analogies.

7.5. Problematic or unacceptable uses

- submitting AI-generated text as your own;
- inventing quotations or references;
- using AI to complete an assessment without permission;
- uploading personal data or sensitive material;
- using AI to pretend that assigned material has been read when it has not.

8. How should the use of generative AI be disclosed and cited?

When generative AI has played a significant role in producing an assignment, that use should be made explicit. The aim is to show how the work was completed, what forms of assistance contributed to it and what role AI played in tasks such as searching for information, organising ideas or writing. The appropriate method may vary according to the subject, the teacher's instructions or the required citation style.

The American Psychological Association provides specific examples for citing generative AI systems and AI chats ([APA, 2026](#)). Other citation systems also provide guidance. The [Modern Language Association \(MLA, 2025\)](#) recommends that AI should not be treated as an author; instead, writers should describe the generated content in the source title, name the specific model used and include a stable, shareable link when one is available. [The Chicago Manual of Style \(Chicago, 2023\)](#) suggests acknowledging AI use in the text or, when a more formal citation is needed, in a footnote or endnote. It also recommends including the generation date and a public link when available. Despite their differences, APA, MLA and Chicago agree that AI use should be made explicit and that responsibility for submitted work remains with the person submitting it.

8.1. Documentation, disclosure and citation are not the same

Documentation means keeping an internal record of how generative AI was used. Depending on the task, this may include the tool and model, the date of use, relevant prompts and responses, and the changes made by the learner. Documentation makes the process traceable and supports later review.

Disclosure means making it clear to a teacher or audience that generative AI contributed to some part of the work. The amount of detail should reflect the extent of the contribution: limited assistance may require only a brief statement, while substantial assistance requires fuller explanation.

Citation means acknowledging AI-generated material according to a particular citation style when the task requires it. If an AI response is quoted, paraphrased or used directly, a citation may be necessary in addition to documentation and disclosure.

Damm and Eaton (2026) emphasise that internal documentation and external disclosure have different audiences and purposes but work together to support transparency, accountability and trust.

8.1.1. Short model AI use statement

In preparing this assignment, I made limited use of generative AI to organise ideas, review the clarity of the text and reformulate some working questions. Its use did not replace the assigned reading or my own analysis and writing.

8.1.2. Illustrative APA Style example (7th edition)

APA provides examples for references to AI systems and AI chats. It also explains that sources other people cannot retrieve are treated as personal communications: they are cited in the text only and are not included in the reference list. It is also advisable to record the system or model used and the date on which the response was generated.

In-text citation

If other people cannot retrieve the AI response, it may be cited in the text as follows:

(OpenAI, personal communication, September 17, 2026)

Retrievable reference

If the conversation or generated response can be accessed through a shareable link, a reference may also be included.

OpenAI. (2026, September 17). ChatGPT response to the prompt “...” [Generative AI chat]. ChatGPT. Shareable URL

Note: These examples are illustrative. How generative AI is cited may vary according to the citation style, the availability of a link and the teacher’s instructions.

8.2. General principle used in this guide

This guide is based on the following principles:

- when generative AI has played a significant role in producing an assignment, that role should be made visible;
- if a text generated entirely by AI is presented as a learner’s own, it becomes less clear how the work was produced;
- generative AI responses do not replace assigned material or other consulted sources;
- the instructions for each task determine whether a use statement is sufficient or a formal citation is also needed;

- this guide uses APA as its main reference while recognising that other citation styles are possible.

When in doubt, prioritise transparency and consult the teacher's specific guidance.

9. Questions to ask before using generative AI

- Does this help me think more effectively, or does it simply complete the task for me?
- Could I explain and defend the final text in my own words?
- Do the task instructions allow this type of use?
- Before I paste or upload anything, does it contain personal, sensitive, school-related or confidential information about me or someone else?
- Do I know what data this tool collects, stores or uses?
- Have I compared this response with assigned material and other sources?
- Does the final text reflect my learning process, judgement and way of thinking?
- Is it clear how generative AI contributed to this work?

10. AI use statement for this guide

Generative AI was used to support the translation, adaptation, organisation and linguistic revision of this guide. The educational criteria, source selection and final decisions were reviewed by Natalia Laguzzi. AI-generated suggestions were critically evaluated and revised before publication.

11. References and further reading

11.1. References

1. Agencia de Acceso a la Información Pública (AAIP). (2024). Guía para entidades públicas y privadas en materia de transparencia y protección de datos personales para una inteligencia artificial responsable [Guide for public and private organisations on transparency and personal data protection for responsible artificial intelligence]. [Source PDF](#).
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7. Ministerio de Educación de la Ciudad Autónoma de Buenos Aires. (2026). IA en la escuela: Guía para un uso crítico (Versión 3.0) [AI at school: A guide to critical use]. [Official resource](#).
8. United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization. (2024). Guidance for generative AI in education and research. [UNESCO Digital Library](#).
9. The Chicago Manual of Style. (2023, March 7). FAQ: Citation, documentation of sources #422. [Chicago Manual of Style](#).

11.2. Further reading

1. United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization. (2022). Recommendation on the ethics of artificial intelligence. [UNESCO Digital Library](#).
2. Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development. (2023). Emerging governance of generative AI in education. In OECD Digital Education Outlook 2023. [OECD](#).